

INITIAL LANGUAGE EVALUATION REPORT

Tiffany FILIPE RODRIGUES

Linguaid France — Confidential Assessment Document

Field	Details
Candidate Name	Tiffany FILIPE RODRIGUES
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Department	Accueil
Job Title	Hôtesse d'accueil
Written Test Date	18 June 2026
Oral Session Date	25 June 2026
Evaluator	Anna MALZY — Linguaid France

1. Executive Summary

Tiffany's combined written and oral assessment places her at a **B1 overall**, with a meaningful split between her receptive and productive skills. Her written test — which measures grammar recognition, reading comprehension, and free writing — returned an overall score of **B1+ (2.5)**, reflecting a solid intermediate competency in understanding and processing English. Her oral assessment, however, revealed a productive speaking level of **A2+ (1.5)**, which is more representative of her spontaneous, real-time communication ability and is the level that matters most in her day-to-day professional role.

This gap between recognition and production is both common and entirely addressable at this stage. Tiffany understands considerably more English than she can currently produce with confidence — a profile that responds very well to targeted, conversation-led training.

Skill	CEFR Level	Score
Grammar (written — MCQ)	B1+	2.5
Writing (free production)	B1	2
Reading / Vocabulary	B1+	2.5
Listening	B1	2
Speaking	A2+	1.5
Overall Combined Level	B1	2

2. Skill-by-Skill Assessment

| 2.1 Grammar

Level: B1+ (2.5)

Strengths

- Tiffany demonstrates reliable command of **basic sentence structure** — subject, verb, and object are consistently in the correct order and her sentences are always intelligible.
- She handles the **present simple** accurately for habitual actions and routines, and deploys **modal and intention structures** (*want to, expect to*) without error.
- Her MCQ score of **73%** confirms that she can **recognise correct grammar** across a range of structures, including more advanced tenses and passive constructions.

Development Areas

- **Present perfect vs. simple present/past** is her most significant and recurring gap. She consistently uses the present simple where English requires the present perfect or present perfect continuous to describe ongoing situations: *"I work since 3 years ago"* → *"I have been working for 3 years."* This pattern appears in both her written and spoken production and is a direct consequence of French L1 transfer (*depuis* + present tense).
- **Since vs. for**: Tiffany uses *since* with duration expressions (*since 3 years*) where *for* is required. These two items — present perfect and the *since/for* distinction — should be treated as a single, high-priority teaching unit.
- **Irregular simple past**: *"I grow up"* → *"I grew up"* — she occasionally defaults to the base form of irregular verbs when narrating past events.
- **Article system**: Omission of the indefinite article before singular countable nouns (*"since I was child"* → *"since I was a child"*) and the definite article in fixed expressions (*"in future"* → *"in the future"*) are recurring minor errors.
- **Capitalisation of the first-person pronoun**: *"i"* appears multiple times across written samples. While minor, this is professionally significant for written communication.

| 2.2 Writing

Level: B1 (2)

Strengths

- Tiffany's written responses are **always communicatively successful** — her meaning is never in doubt and she addresses all three prompts fully and relevantly.

- She uses **contextually appropriate vocabulary** for her professional environment: *reception, events, hospitality* all appear naturally and correctly.
- She can **organise ideas across two domains** (personal and professional) within a short paragraph, demonstrating basic thematic coherence.

Development Areas

- **Tense accuracy in free production** lags behind her receptive MCQ performance — the present perfect errors and irregular past tense forms documented in Section 2.1 appear consistently in her writing.
- **Comma splices**: Independent clauses are joined with a comma alone — *"I grew up in Meudon-la-Forêt, it's a small town..."* — where a relative clause or full stop would be more appropriate. This is a writing mechanics issue addressable at her level.
- **False cognate** — actually*: *Tiffany uses "actually" in the French sense of actuellement (currently). In English, actually means in fact or contrary to expectation**. This is a high-frequency professional error that could create miscommunication in written exchanges with international contacts.
- **Professional collocation precision**: *"work on the events" → "work in events" / "work in event management"* — she lacks the fixed collocations most relevant to her professional goals.
- **Response length and development**: Written answers are brief. At B1+, more developed responses with additional detail and sentence variety would be expected.

| 2.3 Reading and Vocabulary

Level: B1+ (2.5)

Strengths

- Tiffany **correctly interpreted all written prompts** and responded with full relevance — a clear indicator of solid reading comprehension at B1+ level.
- She demonstrates a **functional professional vocabulary range**: *reception, events, hospitality, and travel-related vocabulary* are all used appropriately.
- She is comfortable **discussing personal topics in English** with cultural specificity (e.g. Capoeira, her home region), suggesting her receptive vocabulary extends meaningfully beyond the professional domain.

Development Areas

- **Professional and telephony vocabulary** is a clear priority gap. Her stated professional goals — managing calls, greeting visitors, describing HEC Paris — require a set of functional language chunks (*"How may I direct your call?", "I'll put you through to...", "Could you hold the line, please?"*) that are not yet part of her active repertoire.
- **Lexical precision**: *"little city"* for a commune like Meudon-la-Forêt reflects a direct translation from French. In English, *small town* would be the more natural and accurate register choice.

- **Vocabulary for self-expression under pressure:** As noted during the oral session, when Tiffany cannot retrieve a word in English she switches to French (*commencer, il a toujours voulu, équipe*). Expanding her core professional and general vocabulary is therefore directly linked to building her spoken confidence.

| 2.4 Listening

Level: B1 (2)

Strengths

- Tiffany **followed the oral session without significant difficulty**, demonstrating that she can process spoken English at natural conversational pace on familiar topics.
- She is **bilingual in French and Portuguese** and also speaks Spanish — this strong multilingual foundation supports both her auditory processing and her capacity to acquire new language rapidly.
- She engaged **interactively throughout the session**, confirming comprehension through responses and asking for clarification when needed.

Development Areas

- Listening to **fast-paced, unfamiliar accents** or **topic-dense professional English** (e.g. a multi-part telephone query from an international visitor) is likely to present a greater challenge than the structured oral session. This should be addressed progressively through varied authentic listening input.
- Building **listening stamina** in professional scenarios — longer exchanges, accented speakers, indirect communication styles — will support her primary goal of handling telephone calls confidently.

| 2.5 Speaking

Level: A2+ (1.5)

Strengths

- Tiffany is **chatty, sociable, and genuinely willing to keep a conversation going** — a significant asset for a receptionist role and a strong predictor of training success.
- Her **pronunciation** is good: she is easily understood and does not exhibit phonological features that would impede communication with native or non-native English speakers.
- Her **interaction skills** are strong: she maintains conversational turns, responds to questions, and does not shut down when faced with difficulty.

- **Fluency**, while imperfect grammatically, is functional — she prioritises communication over perfection, which is the right instinct for her professional context.

Development Areas

- **Spontaneous grammar accuracy** is the most significant gap at the spoken level. Errors that appear in writing are amplified in real-time speech: *"I work since 3 years ago"*, *"I like to staying at home"* — tense selection and verb form collapse under the cognitive pressure of real-time production.
- **L1 interference on prepositions**: *"We respond at emails and calls"* → *"We respond to emails and calls"* — prepositional errors are frequent and appear to follow French grammatical patterns directly.
- **Lexical retrieval under pressure**: This is Tiffany's self-identified main stressor. When she cannot find a word, she currently switches to French or asks a colleague to take over the interaction. Building a **core professional vocabulary bank** and practising retrieval strategies will be central to training.
- **Professional register**: Her spoken English is currently limited to a narrow set of repetitive interactions (*"I help and solve problems"* with international students). She lacks the extended professional vocabulary for varied and autonomous communication.
- **Grammar range**: She relies heavily on *want to* and *expect to* for future reference and present simple for most other situations. Expanding her active tense range — particularly the present perfect and a variety of future forms — will significantly increase her expressive range.

3. Learning Objectives

The following three objectives have been validated with Tiffany during the oral session and reflect her confirmed professional goals and stated priorities.

- **Décrire son poste, son équipe et les activités de HEC Paris à l'oral** afin de communiquer de façon autonome avec les visiteurs anglophones.
- **Mener un appel téléphonique professionnel de bout en bout en anglais** pour gérer les demandes entrantes avec confiance.
- **Construire des phrases correctes en utilisant les temps essentiels** afin de réduire les erreurs grammaticales à l'oral et à l'écrit.

4. Training Plan

4.1 Programme Overview

Parameter	Detail
Current Level	B1 overall (Speaking: A2+ / Written: B1+)
Target Level	A2+ → B1 spoken production
Total Hours Allocated	10 hours
Recommended Format	Video call (visio)
Session Format	1-hour sessions, flexible scheduling
Availability	Monday–Friday, mornings and afternoons
Scheduling Notes	Very open and flexible; happy to start immediately

> **Note on hours allocation:** Given that Tiffany's spoken production is currently at A2+ and her primary professional goals are oral (telephone handling, visitor interaction, professional conversation), the 10-hour programme should be **predominantly oral and interaction-focused**, with written accuracy work embedded within spoken tasks rather than treated as a separate strand.

4.2 Suggested Hours Breakdown

Content Area	Suggested Hours
Professional telephone language (greeting, transferring, messaging)	2.5h
Core tense work: present perfect, simple past, future forms	2h
Describing role, company, and activities (oral fluency)	2h
Professional vocabulary building: reception, events, hospitality	1.5h
Informal professional conversation and small talk	1h
Written accuracy: articles, prepositions, false cognates	1h
Total	10h

4.3 Priority Content Areas

- **Present perfect and simple past** — integrated into professional self-description tasks (*"I have been working here for 3 years", "I grew up in..."*)

- **Telephone functional language** — complete interaction sequences with role-play: greeting, holding, transferring, taking messages, closing
- **Core professional vocabulary** — *team, colleague, department, to start, he has always wanted to, to manage, to handle, to assist* — directly replacing the French words Tiffany reached for during the oral session
- **Preposition accuracy** — *respond to, work in, deal with, assist with* — targeting the most frequent L1 interference patterns
- **False cognates** — *actually / currently, eventually / possibly, assist / attend* — high-frequency items in her professional context
- **Describing HEC Paris** — building a reliable oral presentation of her workplace, role, and the institution for use with international visitors and students

| 4.4 Learner Profile Notes for the Trainer

- Tiffany is a **visual learner** — activities incorporating written models, vocabulary maps, and visible sentence structures will be most effective.
- She has **previously attended group English sessions at HEC** but found the level too low. One-to-one training is therefore both appropriate and motivating for her.
- She **becomes stressed when she cannot find her words** and currently avoids English by asking colleagues to step in. Building retrieval strategies and a strong vocabulary base should be treated as a confidence priority, not just a language priority.
- She is **trilingual (French, Portuguese, Spanish)** — this is a genuine cognitive asset. Her trainer may find it useful to leverage her Spanish proximity to English vocabulary when introducing new lexical items.
- She is **highly motivated and wants to start immediately** — early sessions should include quick wins (e.g. mastering a complete telephone interaction sequence) to build momentum and confidence.

5. Evaluator's Narrative Summary

Tiffany is a pleasant, motivated, and communicatively confident candidate whose English profile is characteristic of a capable intermediate learner who has plateaued in a limited professional environment. She currently uses English daily at HEC Paris's reception desk — primarily with international students — but by her own account these interactions are narrow and repetitive, offering little opportunity to expand her range. The result is a spoken level (A2+) that sits meaningfully below her written recognition ability (B1+), a gap that reflects the absence of structured language development rather than any ceiling on her potential.

What stands out most from both the written test and the oral session is the consistency between Tiffany's errors and their cause: the vast majority trace directly to French L1 transfer patterns — the present tense used where English requires the present perfect,

prepositions mapped from French (*respond at* rather than *respond to*), and a tendency to reach for French vocabulary when English retrieval fails under pressure. These are highly predictable patterns at her level and, crucially, highly teachable ones. They do not indicate confusion about meaning — Tiffany always communicates what she intends to communicate — but rather a set of form-to-function mappings that have not yet been fully recalibrated for English.

Her oral strengths are genuinely notable. She is sociable, interactive, and willing to keep a conversation moving even when she feels uncertain — exactly the disposition required of a receptionist in a high-profile international institution. Her pronunciation is clear and her interaction style is warm and engaged. The stress she reports when she cannot find her words is understandable and common at this stage, but it is also a signal that she is aware of the gap between what she wants to express and what she can currently produce. That awareness, combined with her evident motivation and her request to begin training immediately, makes her an excellent candidate for a focused, practical programme.

A 10-hour video-call programme, structured around her confirmed professional goals and built on oral fluency tasks with embedded grammar and vocabulary work, is well-matched to her profile. Priority should be given to the present perfect system, professional telephone sequences, and core vocabulary for her role — the three areas most likely to produce rapid, visible improvement in her day-to-day professional confidence.

6. Sign-Off

Evaluator	Anna MALZY
Organisation	Linguaid France
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